

Trends in age at menarche among Indian girls

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Menarche comes from Greek 'Men' (math) & 'Arche' (begin). It refers to the first menstrual bleeding in a female usually around 12 years.

~~Trend~~ Preconditions for menarche

- ① Atleast 17% of body fat.
- ② Broadened pelvic girdle.
- ③ ~~Dev~~ appearance of breast buds

Trends among Indian girls

There have been a gradual decline in the age of menarche as shown by various studies

- ① Study of Nashik girls from 1960 to 1980: 6 months per decade decline in age of menarche

⑤ Arq Shah study revealed geographical
→ ~~there~~ economic class differences
among girls

→ <u>Gujarat</u> → 14.2 yrs	<u>Urban</u> → 12.8 yrs
<u>Delhi</u> → 12.4 yrs	<u>Rural</u> → 14.8 yrs

Factors for reduction in age

- a) Dietary changes (Sugar Consumption)
- b) Pollution → Exposure to Chemicals
- c) Exposure to ~~media~~ adult media.

— Thus, the secular trend
reveal impact of development on
humans

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